

Best Supplements for Arthritis in the UK

Evidence-based UK guide to arthritis supplements. Compare glucosamine, chondroitin, turmeric, omega-3, collagen and more. What works, what doesn't, and where to buy.

By **Living With Arthritis Editorial Team** · Reviewed by **Clinical Advisory Panel** (HCPC-registered physiotherapy & rheumatology nursing input) · 2026-03-13 · livingwitharthritis.org.uk

With so many supplements marketed for joint health, it can be hard to know what's worth trying. This evidence-based guide reviews the most popular arthritis supplements available in the UK, based on clinical research and expert opinion.

Important Note

No supplement can cure arthritis or replace prescribed medication. Always consult your GP or pharmacist before starting any supplement, especially if you take blood thinners, diabetes medication, or other regular medicines.

Supplements with the Strongest Evidence



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1. Omega-3 Fish Oil

Evidence: Strong for inflammatory arthritis (RA)

- Multiple studies show omega-3s reduce joint pain, stiffness, and inflammation
- Most effective for rheumatoid and psoriatic arthritis
- Recommended dose: 2-3g EPA/DHA daily
- UK brands: Seven Seas, Holland & Barrett, Boots own brand
- Cost: approximately £8-15 per month

2. Turmeric / Curcumin

Evidence: Moderate-strong for pain relief

- Curcumin has anti-inflammatory effects (blocks COX-2 and NF- κ B pathways)

- Multiple trials show 1000mg/day curcumin reduces OA pain comparable to NSAIDs
- Choose a supplement with piperine (black pepper extract) for better absorption
- UK brands: Pukka, Together Health, Bio-Curcumin
- Cost: approximately £10-20 per month

3. Vitamin D

Evidence: Strong for overall bone and joint health

- Deficiency is extremely common in the UK (lack of sunlight)
 - Low vitamin D is linked to increased arthritis pain and disease activity
 - PHE recommends 10mcg (400 IU) daily; some experts suggest up to 1000-2000 IU
 - Available from any pharmacy or supermarket
 - Cost: approximately £3-8 per month
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Supplements with Mixed Evidence

4. Glucosamine and Chondroitin

Evidence: Mixed

- Some studies show modest pain relief in knee OA, others show no benefit
- Glucosamine sulphate (not hydrochloride) has better evidence
- May take 2-3 months to notice effects
- Standard dose: 1500mg glucosamine + 1200mg chondroitin daily
- Not suitable if you have a shellfish allergy (most glucosamine is shellfish-derived)

5. Collagen (Hydrolysed)

Evidence: Emerging but limited

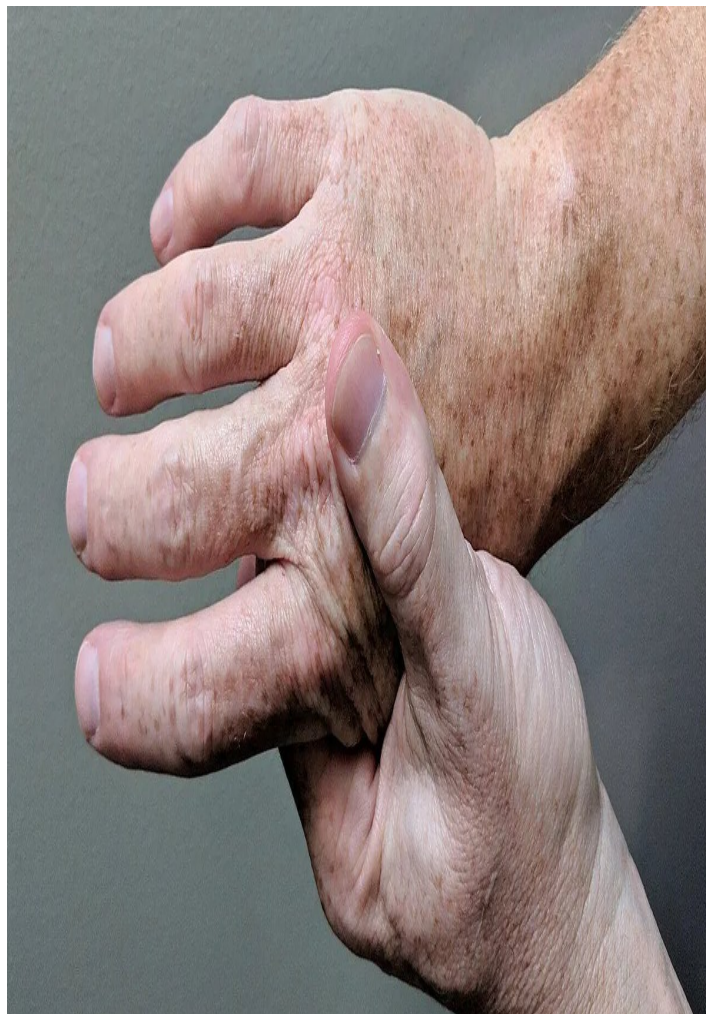
- Some studies show symptom improvement in OA
- May support cartilage repair, but evidence is preliminary
- Standard dose: 10g hydrolysed collagen daily
- UK brands: Vital Proteins, Great Lakes, Hunter & Gather

6. Ginger

Evidence: Moderate for pain relief

- Contains gingerols and shogaols with anti-inflammatory properties
 - Meta-analyses show modest benefit for OA pain
 - 500-1000mg extract daily, or 1-2g fresh ginger
 - Generally safe; may interact with blood thinners
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Where to Buy in the UK



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- Holland & Barrett — widest range of joint health supplements
- Boots — pharmacist advice available in-store
- Amazon UK — competitive prices, check seller ratings

- Independent health food shops — often stock specialist brands

Always check for the MHRA "Traditional Herbal Registration" mark or GMP certification when buying supplements. Speak to your pharmacist about potential interactions with your current medications.

Q&A

Question: What is the key thing to know about best supplements for arthritis in the uk?

Short answer: Omega-3 fish oil and turmeric are recommended for arthritis, with omega-3s reducing inflammation, especially in rheumatoid arthritis, at 2-3g EPA/DHA daily. Turmeric, specifically 1000mg/day curcumin with piperine, can provide pain relief comparable to NSAIDs. Vitamin D at 10mcg (400 IU) daily supports bone health, addressing common deficiencies. Always consult a GP or pharmacist before starting any supplement, especially with other medications.

Question: When should I seek professional advice?

Short answer: If symptoms persist or worsen, pain is severe and unresponsive to usual relief, or you develop new symptoms, contact your GP, physiotherapist or rheumatology team promptly.

Question: Where can I get free arthritis support in the UK?

Short answer: Arthritis UK: 0800 5200 520. NRAS: 0800 298 7650. Free tools and guides at livingwitharthritis.org.uk.

General information only — not medical advice. Consult your GP or specialist before changing medication or starting a new programme. Emergency: 999. NHS advice: 111. Living With Arthritis · livingwitharthritis.org.uk